3R MODEL · Human Capital Digest
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Ukraine faces a triple human capital crisis: diaspora return intentions are weakening, skill shortages are intensifying amid reconstruction, and ongoing airstrikes degrade education quality. Strategic intervention across all three R-pillars is urgent to prevent irreversible talent loss.

Polish survey data shows declining return intentions among Ukrainian refugees, while ILO and OECD simultaneously flag acute skill shortages in reconstruction sectors — the window to activate diaspora talent is narrowing fast.

RETURN

Exiled Ukrainian Women Weigh Life After War

RFI reports that exiled Ukrainian women are actively planning post-war lives, but many are building roots abroad. Return decisions hinge on safety, childcare, and employment prospects. The ambiguity reflects a critical inflection point for diaspora reactivation policy.

3R: Directly signals that without targeted return incentives addressing safety and employment, a large female talent segment will permanently integrate abroad.

RFI

Ukrainian Refugees' Return Intentions Weakening — Poland Study

A UN study cited by Notes from Poland finds Ukrainian refugees contributed 2.4% to Poland's GDP in 2025, while surveys show declining return intentions. Economic integration in host countries is accelerating, making repatriation increasingly difficult.

3R: Quantifies the economic pull keeping diaspora abroad; underscores urgency of competitive return packages and Ukraine-based economic opportunities.

NOTES FROM POLAND

Career Support Model for Returning Parents — CoE Initiative

The Council of Europe is developing a career support model for parents returning to work, noting 600,000+ Ukrainians re-entered employment as of August 2025. The initiative targets reintegration barriers including childcare and skills mismatch.

3R: Provides a concrete policy tool for reactivating displaced parents — a key demographic for return-focused human capital strategy.

COUNCIL OF EUROPE

RECRUIT

ILO Decent Work Programme: Reconstruction Demands Skilled Workforce

The ILO Decent Work Country Programme 2026–2029 highlights that Ukraine's reconstruction is intensifying demand for skilled workers, pressuring education and training systems. It calls for aligned workforce development, social dialogue, and decent work standards.

3R: Defines the strategic skills recruitment agenda for reconstruction; maps gaps that diaspora return and international recruitment could fill.

ILO

20 Ukrainian Tech Companies Expand to Japan — UNDP Mission

UNDP facilitated a trade mission sending 20 Ukrainian tech firms to Japan for business partnerships. This signals Ukraine's tech sector actively recruiting international partnerships and markets, sustaining the sector's global competitiveness.

3R: Tech sector internationalization creates dual-use opportunities: global revenue sustains domestic employment while building talent pipelines with diaspora-connected markets.

UNDP UKRAINE

OECD Mapping Skill Shortages: Ukraine in Focus

The OECD publication launch on mapping skill shortages identifies twin-transition (green/digital) mismatches across member and partner countries. Ukraine's skill gaps in these domains are structurally significant for reconstruction and long-term competitiveness.

3R: Provides evidence base for targeted recruitment of green and digital skills — areas where diaspora professionals and international hires can deliver immediate impact.

OECD

RETAIN

PISA 2025: Ukrainian Students Performing Below Pre-War Levels

VoxUkraine analysis of PISA 2025 shows Ukrainian students scored worse than in 2022 and significantly below pre-war benchmarks, reflecting the devastating impact of air-raid disruptions

on learning continuity and future human capital quality.

3R: A deteriorating education pipeline directly threatens the next generation of domestic talent, making retention of current skilled workers even more critical.

VOXUKRAINE

World Bank: Ukraine Implementing Workforce Capacity Programs

The World Bank ECA Economic Update notes Ukraine among countries implementing workforce capacity programs alongside Kazakhstan, Serbia, and Uzbekistan. These initiatives aim to upskill workers and reduce structural unemployment amid transition pressures.

3R: Upskilling programs are a core retention mechanism; international recognition validates Ukraine's approach and may unlock additional funding for scaling.

WORLD BANK

GLOBAL CONTEXT

Jet Drones as Putin's Strategic Weapon Against Kyiv

Atlantic Council reports relentless jet drone strikes on Kyiv, intensifying civilian infrastructure destruction. The sustained campaign directly undermines the safety conditions necessary for diaspora return and talent retention in Ukraine's capital.

3R: Security environment is the primary determinant of return and retention decisions; escalating strikes on Kyiv create systemic barriers to all three R-pillars.

ATLANTIC COUNCIL

UNHCR Temporary Protection for Ukrainians in Italy

UNHCR Italy outlines temporary protection eligibility for Ukrainian citizens, confirming continued legal status for those displaced since February 2022. This sustained protection framework reduces return urgency and enables longer-term integration abroad.

3R: Extended host-country legal protections correlate with reduced return probability; signals the policy environment working against Ukraine's diaspora reactivation goals.

UNHCR ITALY